

UNIVERSIDAD NACIONAL DEL SUR – Programa de Idioma Inglés
Curso de Lectura Comprensiva de Textos en Inglés – Nivel II
1er PARCIAL (modelo)

Antoine de Saint-Exupéry – A biography

Antoine de Saint-Exupéry is both a pioneer of aviation and a well-known French writer. He was born in Lyon, France, on June 29, 1900. At an early age, he dreamed of a life of adventure and wanted to become a naval officer. Unfortunately, he **failed** the exam to qualify him for naval officer training school. As a result, he turned his attention to the field of aviation. **Even though flying was dangerous and risky in Saint-Exupéry's time,** he joined the military and trained to be a pilot.

After his military service, **he presented himself to the director of an airline company and expressed his desire to become a commercial pilot.** The director told him he **must first become** an airplane mechanic. Finally, in 1927, Saint-Exupéry became a pilot, opening up new air routes over the Mediterranean Sea, North Africa, and the Sahara Desert. Because of the danger of flying, he had a number of accidents, but he escaped any major injuries. Later, Saint-Exupéry became the director of his own aviation company in South America, where he often flew dangerous routes over the Andes Mountains.

For Saint-Exupéry, **flying was not just piloting an airplane;** it was a time for meditation and reflection. While in the air, Saint-Exupéry **would think** deeply about solitude, friendship, the meaning of life, the human condition, and liberty. He decided to publish his reflections into a book, which was successful. When his aviation company failed, Saint-Exupéry decided to pursue writing as a career. He first became a journalist, traveling to Spain, Russia, and Germany. He also wrote two philosophical books based on aviation: *Night Flight* (1932) and *Wind, Sand, and Stars* (1939). Still in love with piloting an airplane, Saint-Exupéry **continued to fly whenever he had the opportunity.**

In 1939, when France went to war with Germany, Saint-Exupéry immediately enlisted in the army, hoping to become a military pilot in the war effort. France, however, was soon defeated and occupied by Hitler's troops. Saint-Exupéry decided to leave his homeland, settle in the United States, and pursue his writing career. **It was in New York that he published *The Little Prince*,** which was his most celebrated book, in 1943. Since its first publication, more than 25 million copies **have been sold** in 75 different countries.

In 1942, the year when American troops landed in North Africa, Saint-Exupéry decided to join the U.S. army as a pilot. Since he was 42 years of age, he was initially considered too old to be a pilot and was not allowed to fly; however, Saint-Exupéry persisted and was finally given an airplane. He accomplished many missions over occupied France. On July 31, 1944, Saint-Exupéry left for his last mission. His plane **was destroyed** by the Germans over the Mediterranean.

1. Leer rápidamente el texto completo e **indicar el orden** en el que aparecen las siguientes informaciones:

----- **a.** *Como piloto comercial, Saint-Exupéry sobrevivió a varios accidentes.*

----- **b.** *Se publicó su libro más famoso.*

- *c. Saint-Exupéry deseaba ser oficial de la marina.*
- *d. Logró que lo aceptaran como piloto de guerra.*
- *e. Saint-Exupéry comenzó su carrera como escritor.*

2. Responder en español las siguientes preguntas:

- a.** When did Saint-Exupéry become interested in aviation?
- b.** What job did he have before becoming a commercial pilot?
- c.** What were his books about?
- d.** What did Saint-Exupéry do when Germany occupied France?
- e.** Why was it difficult for him to join the US army?

3. Marcar tres (3) oraciones subordinadas con distinto pronombre relativo en el texto. Indicar el principio y el fin con paréntesis y expresarlas en español:

- 1.**
- 2.**
- 3.**

4. En el texto aparecen los siguientes verbos. Indicar con una cruz (x) si se encuentran en voz activa o pasiva y proponer una versión en español:

Frase Verbal	Línea	Voz Activa	Voz Pasiva	Traducción
failed	3			
must (first) become	8-9			
would think	15			
have been sold	29			
was destroyed	36			

5. Buscar las **frases subrayadas** y expresarlas **en español** de acuerdo al contexto en el que aparecen:

a.

b.

c.

d.

e.